could perform like a Patriot, and so on. Hearing a “Yes” or a “Why not?” from me, people’s faces would light up with pride and satisfaction.

The Al ied Forces had a marked technological edge, as they were fielding systems built using the technologies of the eighties and nineties. Iraq was fighting with the by-and-large vintage weapon systems of the sixties and seventies. Now, this is where the key to the modern world order lies— superiority through technology. Deprive the opponent of the latest technology and then dictate your terms in an unequal contest. When the Chinese war philosopher, Sun Tzu ruminated over 2000 years ago that what matters in war is not decimating the enemy army physical y but breaking his wil so as to make him concede defeat in the mind, he seems to have visualized the domination of technology in the twentieth century theatres of war. The missile force coupled with the electronic warfare used in the Gulf War was a feast for military strategic experts. It acted as a curtainraiser for the twenty-first century war scenario with missiles and electronic and information warfare playing the lead roles.

In India, even today, the term technology, for most